



— FREE OWNER'S CHECKLIST

Google Business Profile & Reviews Checklist

When someone nearby searches for a place like yours, your Google profile is often the first thing they see, before your website. Here's how to get it right and keep the reviews coming.

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- Claim and verify your profile
 - Photos that sell
 - Replying to reviews (with templates)
 - Fill in every field
 - Getting more reviews, the right way
 - A 15-minute monthly routine

STEP 1

Claim and verify your profile

- ☐ Search your business name on Google Maps. If a listing exists, choose "Claim this business". If not, add it at business.google.com.
- ☐ Sign in with a Google account the **business** controls, not a former employee's or an agency's personal one.
- ☐ Complete verification. Google chooses the method (for example a code, a call or a short video). Your profile isn't fully live until it's verified.
- ☐ Add a second owner or manager, so you're never locked out if one person leaves.

STEP 2

Fill in every field

A complete profile gives Google, and customers, more reasons to choose you.

FIELD	GET IT RIGHT	DONE
Business name	Exactly as it appears on your sign. Don't add keywords or city names. Google's guidelines don't allow it.	☐
Categories	The primary category matters most. Pick the most specific one (e.g. "Pizza restaurant", not just "Restaurant"), then add a few secondary ones.	☐
Address / service area	Match your website and other listings exactly, down to "Rd" vs "Road".	☐
Phone and website	A phone that's answered during open hours, and your real website.	☐
Hours	Regular hours plus holiday hours. Update them before every holiday.	☐
Description	Up to 750 characters: what you are, what you're known for, who you serve. Write it for people, not for search engines.	☐
Menu / products / services	Add your menu or main products with prices where you can.	☐
Ordering and booking links	Link your own online ordering or reservations, so orders come to you.	☐
Attributes	Tick everything that applies: outdoor seating, takeout, delivery, wheelchair access, payment types.	☐

— STEP 3

Photos that sell

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Logo and a cover photo | ☐ Your best-selling dishes or products |
| ☐ The outside, as customers see it from the street | ☐ Your team at work (with their OK) |
| ☐ The inside: dining room, bar, counter or aisles | ☐ New photos every month, taken in good light |

— STEP 4

Getting more reviews, the right way

Do

- ☐ Get your review link: in your Business Profile, find "Ask for reviews" and copy the link Google gives you.
- ☐ Ask at the right moment: right after a great meal, a compliment or a smooth checkout.
- ☐ Make it easy: put the link in a QR code on table tents, the counter or the door, and in follow-up texts or emails.
- ☐ Ask everyone. Don't only ask the customers you think are happy.
- ☐ Train staff on one simple line, e.g. "If you enjoyed it, a Google review really helps us."

Don't (these break Google's review policies)

- ☐ Don't offer discounts, freebies or anything else in exchange for reviews.
- ☐ Don't write reviews for your own business or ask staff or family to.
- ☐ Don't screen customers so that only happy ones are asked to review.
- ☐ Don't buy reviews or use a service that posts them for you.

— STEP 5

Replying to reviews

Reply to every review, good and bad, within a few days. Future customers read your replies as closely as the reviews. Keep it short, specific and human.

FIVE STARS

Thanks so much, [name]! Glad you loved the [dish / product they mentioned]. We'll see you next time. [Your name], [role]

GOOD, WITH A SMALL COMPLAINT

Thanks for coming in, [name], and for the honest feedback about [issue]. We've shared it with the team and we're on it. Hope to see you again. [Your name]

NEGATIVE

[Name], I'm sorry your visit wasn't what it should have been. That's not the standard we hold ourselves to. I'd like to make it right: please reach me directly at [phone or email]. [Your name], [role]

NOT A REAL CUSTOMER / WRONG BUSINESS

We couldn't find a record of this visit and want to look into it. Please contact us at [phone or email] so we can help. [Your name]

Ground rules

- ☐ Never argue in public, share a customer's details, or blame staff by name.
- ☐ Take problems offline: give a direct way to reach a manager.
- ☐ If a review breaks Google's policies (spam, offensive, or clearly about another business), report it from your profile instead of arguing with it.

This checklist is general guidance. Google's features and policies change, so check Google's current Business Profile help pages. © EPAY POS.

STEP 6

Keep your details the same everywhere

Your name, address and phone should match, character for character, on every listing.

LISTING	NAME, ADDRESS, PHONE MATCH?	HOURS CURRENT?
Your website	☐	☐
Google Business Profile	☐	☐
Apple Maps (Apple Business Connect)	☐	☐
Bing Places	☐	☐
Yelp	☐	☐
Facebook / Instagram	☐	☐
Delivery apps	☐	☐

STEP 7

Your 15-minute monthly routine

TASK	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN
Reply to every new review						
Add 3+ new photos						
Post an update, offer or event						
Check hours (and holiday hours)						
Answer new customer questions						
Check menu / products are current						

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